6.6.2.2 Creating Optical Illusions

A change in appearance of an area by means of proportion might involve the lengthening or broadening effects of vertical and horizontal lines. Lines running in a vertical direction tend to slenderize and make an object appear taller, whereas lines running in a horizontal direction would make an object appear shorter and broader. (Figure 6.27)

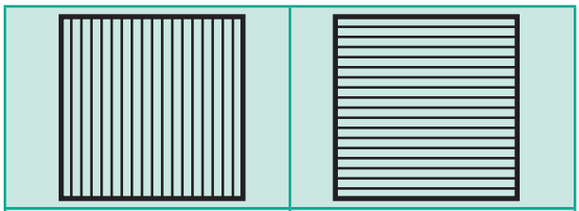


Figure 6.27 Optical illusions

6.6.2.3 Scale

The third aspect of proportions is called scale. It is the capacity to select designs and arrange them so that they look well together. The design principles of scale is related to proportion. Both proportion and scale deal with the relative's sizes of things. Proportion pertains to the relationship between the parts of a composition and scale refers specially to the size of something, relative to some known standard or recognized constant. Scale, in this sense means,

that the size of all the elements making up the structure have a consistent, pleasing relationship to the structure and to each other, and that the size of the structure is in good proportion to the different objects combined with it.

A very small object will never look so small as when it is placed near a very large one. That is because the two sizes are not consistent. In a consistent scale, it is possible to create illusion that causes astonishment when the actual sizes of objects are realized.

Proportion in Colour

This principle applies to colour as much as to sizes. Colour combinations are more beautiful when the amounts are varied, than when they are equal. Proportion holds good here but if the colours are very different in their forcefulness, they should be arranged according to the "Law of Areas", and the brighter colours used in smaller amounts.

6.6.3 Rhythm

Rhythm is a very important art principle. According to Beitler and Lockhart,'a sense of order, a quality of gracefulness, a feeling of easy movement' – all lead to a principle of design; which is called as "rhythm".

Rhythm is related movement or the sense of leading the eye from one part of a design to another in an easy, flowing manner. Rhythm is organized movement in continuity. It occurs in regular, repeated movement and also in variable transitional movement.

Rhythm may be defined as a form of movement. But not all movement in design is rhythmic. Rhythm means an easy, connected path, along which the eye may travel in any arrangement of lines, forms or colours. Rhythmic movements can be achieved through repetition of shapes, progression of sizes, continuous line movement, radiation and gradation

6.6.3a. Rhythm through Repetition

A feeling of rhythm may be expressed by repetition of lines, colours and shapes. When a shape is regularly repeated at

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